London 2005 bombings) and in particular attacks after 2014 that came as one of the (indirect) consequences of the invasion of Iraq and civil strife in the wider Middle East, as well as a result of failed integration of radicalised individuals, were also used as a useful argument that these migrants, especially the young men among them, represent a security threat for Europe. Hungary and most of the rest of Central Europe was taken aback by the average Western European's apparent complete ignorance of the cultural challenge that such masses of devout or outright radicalised Muslims represent. As a result, chaotic and unpleasant scenes could be seen in Hungary of migrants not being welcome, which inspired Angela Merkel to suspend the EU legislation and accept migrants *en masse*, while Hungary embarked on building a new fence, resembling a wall, which was only recently brought down.

Chancellor Merkel was widely praised for her actions abroad and at home – except in the former Eastern Germany. While media and analysts did notice different reactions in this part of Germany, few took the trouble of looking under the surface of the alleged xenophobia of the former Communist lands. (In that respect, the former DDR offered an excellent living laboratory.) These people seemed just so selfish and ungrateful. Together with Central European countries, which resisted the plan for distribution of the migrants among EU countries, they were named and shamed for their alleged lack of sympathy for those in need of refuge. They were reminded how the West took care of those fleeing over the Iron Curtain during the Communist years. In this picture, Hungary and Poland stood out, seeing the arrival of masses of many young males (after the first wave of mainly women, children and families) foremost as a security issue and, what was most controversial and difficult to understand in the West, as a threat to Christian nations of Europe and their way of life. The truth was that by then, few in the West cared about Christian tradition. And even those that did, thought that – much to the annoyance of Eastern Europe – it was precisely this Christian tradition that required nothing less than a warm welcome of the migrants.

On the surface, the idea of redistribution of refugees/migrants across Europe seemed noble and reasonable: Greece, Malta and Italy had been for a very long time unfairly carrying the bulk of the burden of migration, due to an unworkable EU rule requiring the country of the first entry to process